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Web Security Academy > Information disclosure > Exploiting > Lab

Lab: Information disclosure on debug page

APPRENTICE

This lab contains a debug page that discloses sensitive information about the application. To solve the lab, obtain and submit the `SECRET_KEY` environment variable.

[ACCESS THE LAB](#)

Solution

- With Burp running, browse to the home page.
- Go to the "Target" > "Site Map" tab. Right-click on the top-level entry for the lab and select "Engagement tools" > "Find comments". Notice that the home page contains an HTML comment that contains a link called "Debug". This points to `/cgi-bin/phpinfo.php`.
- In the site map, right-click on the entry for `/cgi-bin/phpinfo.php` and select "Send to Repeater".
- In Burp Repeater, send the request to retrieve the file. Notice that it reveals various debugging information, including the `SECRET_KEY`

Host	Method	URL	Params	Status code	Length
https://portswigger.net	POST	/api/widgets?		200	8031
https://portswigger.net	POST	/api/widgets?		200	8059
https://portswigger.net	POST	/api/widgets?		200	12598
https://portswigger.net	GET	/bundles/static-content/public...		200	26750
https://portswigger.net	GET	/bundles/static-content/public...		200	4161
https://portswigger.net	GET	/bundles/users/login.js?v=Y5w...		200	96684
https://portswigger.net	GET	/bundles/users/youraccount.js...		200	149380
https://portswigger.net	GET	/bundles/widgets/register.js?v...		200	18572
https://portswigger.net	GET	/content/images/banners/ban...		200	101486

Request	Raw	Hex	Response	Raw	Hex	Rem
1 POST /api/widgets? HTTP/2			1 HTTP/2 200 OK			
2 Host: portswigger.net			2 Content-Type: application			
3 Cookie: ma-user=id=...			3 Date: Sun, 23 Nov 2025 10			
4 ...			4 Cross-Origin-Opener-Polic...			
5 ...			5 Server: Mozilla/5.0 (MacInt...			
6 ...			6 Cache-Control: no-store,			
7 ...			7 Set-Cookie: AspNetCore.M...			
8 ...			8 Set-Cookie: ASP.NETCore.M...			
9 ...			9 Set-Cookie: ASP.NETCore.M...			
10 ...			10 Set-Cookie: ASP.NETCore.M...			
11 ...			11 Set-Cookie: ASP.NETCore.M...			
12 ...			12 Set-Cookie: ASP.NETCore.M...			
13 ...			13 X-Content-Type-Options: n...			
14 ...			14 X-Frame-Options: SAMEORIG			
15 ...			15 X-Header-Extensions: 1; s...			
16 ...			16 Content-Security-Policy: ...			

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Lab: Source code disclosure via backup files

APPRENTICE

This lab leaks its source code via backup files in a hidden directory. To solve this lab, identify and submit the database password, which is hard-coded in the source code.

ACCESS THE LAB

Solution

- Browse to `/robots.txt` and notice that it reveals the existence of `/backup` directory. Browse to `/backup` to find the file `ProductTemplate.java.bak`. Alternatively, right-click on the lab, launch a content discovery session to discover the `/backup` directory and its contents.
- Browse to `/backup/ProductTemplate.java.bak` to access the source code.
- In the source code, notice that the connection builder contains the hard-coded password for a Postgres database.

Index of /backup

Name	Size
ProductTemplate.java.bak	1647B

Burp Suite Community Edition v2025.10.5 - Temporary Project

DashboardTargetProxyIntruderRepeaterCollaboratorSequencerDecoderComparerLoggerOrganizerExtensions

Site map filter: Hiding not found items; hiding CSS, image and general binary content; hiding 4xx responses; hiding empty folders

Host	Method	URL	Params	Status code	Length	MIME type	Title
https://portswigger.n...	POST	/api/widgets?		200	8031	JSON	
https://portswigger.n...	POST	/api/widgets?		200	8059	JSON	
https://portswigger.n...	POST	/api/widgets?		200	12598	JSON	
https://portswigger.n...	POST	/api/widgets?		200	8052	JSON	
https://portswigger.n...	GET	/bundles/static-conte...		200	25750	script	
https://portswigger.n...	GET	/bundles/static-conte...		200	4161	script	
https://portswigger.n...	GET	/bundles/users/login...		200	96684	script	
https://portswigger.n...	GET	/bundles/users/youra...		200	149380	script	
https://portswigger.n...	GET	/bundles/widgets/regi...		200	18572	script	

Request

Response

Inspector

1 POST /api/widgets? HTTP/2 200 OK

2 Host: portswigger.net

3 Cookies: aa-user-id=a%253A0-e4700e45-99ec-5602-7e77-3ae406e71a-e9_QWZLzUlyyV0VCS2BQ-h19vcPrintU707EPgcQW0B7057TypeT:aa-user-id-v2=a%253A38A9p2ba9Wj_5e53B9oaeCTW6nA_ScamTCT1

1 HTTP/2 200 OK

2 Content-Type: application/json; charset=utf-8

3 Date: Sun, 23 Nov 2025 10:51:02 GMT

4 Cross-Origin-Opener-Policy: same-origin

5 Server: Fastest

6 Cache-Control: no-store, no-cache, s-max-age=0, private

Web Security Academy

Authentication bypass via information disclosure

LAB Solved

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Users

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